

Homework 6

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*All of my homework is available at <https://github.com/lacampanella233/Homework.git>.

Problem 1 (5A-29). Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{R}^3)$ and -4 , 5 , and $\sqrt{7}$ are eigenvalues of T . Prove that there exists $x \in \mathbb{R}^3$ such that

$$Tx - 9x = (-4, 5, \sqrt{7}).$$

Proof. Since -4 , 5 , and $\sqrt{7}$ are eigenvalues of $T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{R}^3)$, we can infer that 9 is not an eigenvalue, hence $\ker(T - 9I) = \{0\}$. Therefore, $T - 9I$ is injective. Since $\mathbb{R}^3$ is finite-dimensional, injectivity implies surjectivity. Thus, for any vector v in $\mathbb{R}^3$, there exists a vector $x \in \mathbb{R}^3$ such that $Tx - 9x = v$. Take $v = (-4, 5, \sqrt{7})$, then the problem has been proved. $\square$

Problem 2 (5A-30). Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$ and

$$(T - 2I)(T - 3I)(T - 4I) = 0.$$

Suppose λ is an eigenvalue of T . Prove that $\lambda = 2$ or $\lambda = 3$ or $\lambda = 4$.

Proof. Take $v \neq 0$ such that $Tv = \lambda v$. Then

$$0 = (T - 2I)(T - 3I)(T - 4I)v = (\lambda - 2)(\lambda - 3)(\lambda - 4)v \implies \lambda \in \{2, 3, 4\}.$$

$\square$

Problem 3 (5A-38). Suppose V is finite-dimensional, $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$, and U is a subspace of V invariant under T . The quotient operator $T/U \in \mathcal{L}(V/U)$ is defined by

$$(T/U)(v + U) = Tv + U$$

for each $v \in V$.

- (a) Show that the definition of T/U makes sense (which requires using the condition that U is invariant under T) and show that T/U is an operator on V/U .
- (b) Show that each eigenvalue of T/U is an eigenvalue of T .

Proof. (a) For any $v_1, v_2 \in V$ such that $v_1 + U = v_2 + U$, we know that $u := v_1 - v_2 \in U$. Then

$$\begin{aligned}(T/U)(v_1 + U) &= T(v_1) + U = T(v_2 + u) + U = T(v_2) + Tu + U \\ &= T(v_2) + U = (T/U)(v_2 + U).\end{aligned}$$

Then T/U is well-defined.

(b) Take an eigenvalue and corresponding eigenvector of T/U , say λ and $v + U$. Note that $v + U \neq U$, so $v \notin U$. Then $Tv + U = (T/U)(v + U) = \lambda(v + U) = \lambda v + U$, which implies that $Tv = \lambda v + u$ for some $u \in U$.

If λ is not an eigenvalue of T , then $T - \lambda I$ is injective in V , as well as in U (because U is T -invariant). Then there exists $u_0 \in U$ such that $Tu_0 - \lambda u_0 = u \in U$.

Set $v' = v - u_0$. Since $v \notin U$, we have $v' \neq 0$. And by the definition of u_0 , we have

$$Tv' = Tv - Tu_0 = \lambda v + u - (\lambda u_0 + u) = \lambda(v - u_0) = \lambda v'.$$

This contradicts the assumption that λ is not an eigenvalue of T . Therefore, λ is an eigenvalue of T . $\square$

Problem 4 (5A-42). Define $T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^n)$ by

$$T(x_1, x_2, x_3, \dots, x_n) = (x_1, 2x_2, 3x_3, \dots, nx_n).$$

- (a) Find all eigenvalues and eigenvectors of T .
- (b) Find all subspaces of $\mathbb{F}^n$ that are invariant under T .

Solution. (a) The representation of T under the standard basis is $\text{diag}(1, 2, \dots, n)$, then all eigenvalues and eigenvectors of T are

$$k \text{ and } (0, \dots, 0, \overset{(k \text{ th})}{1}, 0, \dots, 0), \quad k = 1, 2, \dots, n.$$

(b) We will prove that the invariant subspaces of T are exactly those spanned by a subset of the standard basis, i.e. those of the form

$$V_S := \{a_1, \dots, a_n \in \mathbb{F}^n : a_i = 0 \text{ for all } i \notin S\}, \text{ where } S \subseteq \{1, 2, \dots, n\}.$$

Obviously, V_S is invariant under T for any $S \subseteq \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$.

Conversely, take an invariant subspace U of T . For any $v = (a_1, a_2, \dots, a_n)$, Define

$$N(v) = \{k \in \{1, 2, \dots, n\} : a_k \neq 0\},$$

$$v_- = \min \{|a_i| : i \in N(v)\}, \quad v_+ = \max \{|a_i| : i \in N(v)\}.$$

Then, let $S = \bigcup_{u \in U} N(u)$. We will show that $U = V_S$. Obviously $U \subset V_S$, so it suffices to prove that $V_S \subset U$.

First, we will show that there exists $x \in U$ such that $N(x) = S$. Denote S by $S := \{s_1 < \dots < s_m\}$. For each s_i , there exists $u_i \in U$ such that $s_i \in N(u_i)$. We will construct x inductively by following steps:

- Take $x_1 = u_1$. Then the s_1 -th component of x_1 is nonzero.

- Once we have chosen x_k such that s_i -th component of x_k is nonzero for all $1 \leq i \leq k$. If the s_{k+1} -th component of x_k is nonzero, then take $x_{k+1} = x_k$; otherwise let

$$x_{k+1} = x_k + \frac{(x_k)_-}{2(u_{k+1})_+} u_{k+1}.$$

The s_{k+1} -th component of x_{k+1} is nonzero due to the choice of u_{k+1} ; for any $s_{i(\leq k)}$ -th component of x_{k+1} , we have

$$\left| x_{k+1}^{(s_i)} \right| = \left| x_k^{(s_i)} + \frac{(x_k)_-}{2(u_{k+1})_+} u_{k+1}^{s_i} \right| \geq \left| x_k^{(s_i)} \right| - \frac{(x_k)_-}{2(u_{k+1})_+} \left| u_{k+1}^{(s_i)} \right| \geq \left| x_k^{(s_i)} \right| - \frac{1}{2} (x_k)_- > 0.$$

Then the s_i -th component of x_{k+1} is nonzero.

Hence, we have constructed x_{k+1} such that the s_i -th ($1 \leq i \leq k+1$) components are nonzero.

- Finally, we have $x = x_m$ such that $N(x) = S$.

Next, we will show that $V_S \subset \text{span}\{x, Tx, \dots, T^{m-1}x\} \subset U$.

Denote $a_i := x^{(s_i)}$ for any $1 \leq i \leq m$. Then, for any $v \in V$ ($v^{(s_i)} = b_i$), the equation

$$\begin{cases} \lambda_1 a_1 & + \lambda_2 a_1 & + \lambda_3 a_1 & + \dots & + \lambda_m a_1 & = b_1, \\ \lambda_1 a_2 & + \lambda_2 2a_2 & + \lambda_3 2^2 a_2 & + \dots & + \lambda_m 2^{m-1} a_2 & = b_2, \\ \lambda_1 a_3 & + \lambda_2 3a_3 & + \lambda_3 3^2 a_3 & + \dots & + \lambda_m 3^{m-1} a_3 & = b_3, \\ \dots & & & & & \\ \lambda_1 a_m & + \lambda_2 m a_m & + \lambda_m m^2 a_m & + \dots & + \lambda_m m^{m-1} a_m & = b_m \end{cases}$$

has a solution $(\lambda_1, \dots, \lambda_m)$ because the coefficient matrix is a Vandermonde matrix. Hence,

$$v = \sum_{i=1}^m \lambda_i T^{i-1} x \in \text{span}\{x, Tx, \dots, T^{m-1}x\} \subset U.$$

Therefore, $V_S \subset U$.

In conclusion, the invariant subspaces of T are exactly those of the form V_S for some $S \subseteq \{1, 2, \dots, n\}$.

Problem 5 (5A-43). Suppose that V is finite-dimensional, $\dim V > 1$, and $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Prove that

$$\{p(T) : p \in \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{F})\} \neq \mathcal{L}(V).$$

Proof. Denote $P = \{p(T) : p \in \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{F})\} \neq \mathcal{L}(V)$. It's easy to verify that P is a subspace of $\mathcal{L}(V)$.

Denote $d := \deg \min_T(x) \leq n$. We will show that $\dim P = d < n^2 = \dim \mathcal{L}(V)$, which implies $P \neq \mathcal{L}(V)$.

First, $I, T, T^2, \dots, T^{d-1}$ is linearly independent in $\mathcal{L}(V)$, otherwise there exists not-all-zero $a_0, a_1, \dots, a_{d-1} \in \mathbb{F}$ such that

$$\sum_{k=0}^{d-1} a_k T^k = 0 \implies \min_T(x) \left| \sum_{k=0}^{d-1} a_k x^k \right| \implies a_k = 0 \text{ for all } 0 \leq k \leq d-1,$$

which contradicts the choice of $a_0, a_1, \dots, a_{d-1}$. Hence, $\dim P \geq d$.

Next, we will show that $I, T, T^2, \dots, T^{d-1}$ spans P . For any $p(T) \in P$, we can write $p(x) = q(x) \min_T(x) + r(x)$ for some $q, r \in \mathcal{P}(\mathbb{F})$ such that $r = 0$ or $\deg r < d$. Then

$$p(T) = q(T) \min_T(T) + r(T) = r(T) \in \text{span} \{I, T, T^2, \dots, T^{d-1}\}.$$

Hence, $\dim P \leq d$.

In conclusion, $\dim P = d < n^2 = \dim \mathcal{L}(V)$, which implies $P \neq \mathcal{L}(V)$. $\square$

Problem 6 (5B-7).

- (a) Give an example of $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^2)$ such that the minimal polynomial of ST does not equal the minimal polynomial of TS .
- (b) Suppose V is finite-dimensional and $S, T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Prove that if at least one of S, T is invertible, then the minimal polynomial of ST equals the minimal polynomial of TS .

Problem 7 (5B-16). Suppose $a_0, \dots, a_{n-1} \in \mathbb{F}$. Let T be the operator on $\mathbb{F}^n$ whose matrix (with respect to the standard basis) is

$$\begin{pmatrix} 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -a_0 \\ 1 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -a_1 \\ 0 & 1 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -a_2 \\ \vdots & \vdots & \vdots & \ddots & \vdots & \vdots \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 0 & -a_{n-2} \\ 0 & 0 & 0 & \cdots & 1 & -a_{n-1} \end{pmatrix}.$$

Here all entries of the matrix are 0 except for all 1's on the line under the diagonal and the entries in the last column (some of which might also be 0). Show that the minimal polynomial of T is the polynomial

$$a_0 + a_1 z + \cdots + a_{n-1} z^{n-1} + z^n.$$

Problem 8 (5B-20). Suppose $T \in \mathcal{L}(\mathbb{F}^4)$ is such that the eigenvalues of T are 3, 5, 8. Prove that

$$(T - 3I)^2(T - 5I)^2(T - 8I)^2 = 0.$$

Problem 9 (5B-21). Suppose V is finite-dimensional and $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Prove that the minimal polynomial of T has degree at most $1 + \dim \text{range } T$.

Problem 10 (5B-22). Suppose V is finite-dimensional and $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$. Prove that T is invertible if and only if

$$I \in \text{span}(T, T^2, \dots, T^{\dim V}).$$

Problem 11 (5B-25). Suppose V is finite-dimensional, $T \in \mathcal{L}(V)$, and U is a subspace of V that is invariant under T .

(a) Prove that the minimal polynomial of T is a polynomial multiple of the minimal polynomial of the quotient operator T/U .

(b) Prove that

$$(\text{minimal polynomial of } T|_U) \times (\text{minimal polynomial of } T/U)$$

is a polynomial multiple of the minimal polynomial of T .

Problem 12 (5B-29). Show that every operator on a finite-dimensional vector space of dimension at least two has an invariant subspace of dimension two.